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General Comment

Allowing AI to train on creative materials without approval or compensation from the copyright holders is a form of theft that undermines the very foundation of artistic and intellectual labor. Authors, designers, and other creators invest time, skill, and originality into their work, expecting recognition and fair compensation for their efforts. When AI models ingest these works without permission, they strip creators of control over their own intellectual property, exploiting their labor without providing anything in return. This not only devalues individual contributions but also discourages future creativity, as artists and writers may find it increasingly difficult to sustain themselves in a system that freely extracts their work for profit. Ultimately, unchecked AI training erodes the incentives for original creation, leading to a cultural landscape where innovation is stifled, and authentic voices are drowned out by machine-generated imitations.